

Clinical Necessity for Joined Crowns

3 messages

Neill Ryan <neillk2@yahoo.com>

Çar, Ara 11, 2024 at 5:03 ÖS

To: "OrbisMed Clinics - Booking" <booking@orbismedclinics.com>

Dear Yagiz,

Thank you for providing the documents related to my treatment. After reviewing the consent form and associated paperwork, I remain unconvinced that my concerns have been adequately addressed.

While the consent form I signed acknowledges my agreement to undergo treatment, it does not explicitly state or provide details about the use of joined (splinted) crowns. The paperwork I signed specifically refers to 26 zirconium crowns, with no mention of any changes to the proposed plan or the use of 12 joined crowns (5 lower and 7 upper), which is what I have ended up with.

The reason I could not have consented to the treatment I received is because the very first time I was made aware of the use of joined crowns was during the fitting process, which, as you know, occurs some days after the consent form is signed.

At this time, the use of joined crowns was not presented to me as my choice but was explained to me as a "standard procedure." I was simply shown some of my joined crowns after they had been made and told, words to the effect of, "this is the way we do it because it's better."

It was my belief at that time that OrbisMed uses joined crowns in all cases and that there was no other option for me. At this stage, with my teeth already shaved and a flight home scheduled for the next morning, I was in absolutely no position to weigh up the risks or benefits or properly consent.

If OrbisMed believes that this would constitute informed patient consent, then this would be very concerning indeed.

Summary of Key Concerns:

1. Lack of Evidence Supporting Clinical Necessity,

You have not provided sufficient or specific evidence explaining why the use of joined crowns was necessary in my case, particularly on my healthy teeth.

2. No Documentation of Informed Consent

There is no documentation showing that I had prior knowledge of the use of 12 joined crowns or that I gave my informed consent for this significant deviation from the agreed treatment plan of 26 crowns.

3. Timing of Communication

The decision to use joined crowns was communicated to me only at the final fitting stage, leaving me no opportunity to make an informed decision.

Actions Required

I still require an explanation for these deviations from the agreed treatment plan and documentation substantiating the necessity of using joined crowns on normal, healthy teeth.

Additionally, I would like confirmation of the specific measures you will take to address my concerns, including the possibility of replacing joined crowns with individual crowns, as previously discussed.

Proposal for Lower Teeth Replacement

Furthermore, I would like to fully understand the proposal for my lower teeth. How will these be replaced, and what assurances can you provide that my teeth will not be harmed during this process? If any of my underlying teeth are compromised during the replacement process, what solution will be offered?

I trust you will take my concerns seriously and provide a comprehensive response that addresses them fully.

Kind regards,

Neill Ryan

On Wednesday, December 11, 2024 at 09:20:43 AM GMT, OrbisMed Clinics - Booking <booking@orbismedclinics.com> wrote:

Thank you for your detailed email and for sharing your concerns regarding your treatment. We understand the importance of addressing your points comprehensively and transparently, and we are committed to working with you to clarify and resolve these matters.

Firstly, regarding the clinical justification for the use of joined (splinted) crowns, we have already provided a detailed explanation in the clinical necessity letter sent in our prior correspondence. In addition to this, as part of our commitment to transparency, we are attaching the following documents for your review:

- Your full medical history
- The original treatment plan
- Pre- and post-treatment X-rays
- The signed consent form
- The signed satisfaction form
- Your invoice

These documents should provide a clear overview of the clinical decision-making process and the steps taken during your treatment.

In response to your concern that this treatment approach was not communicated to you before the procedure, we want to emphasize that our clinicians make every effort to communicate the details of the proposed treatments during consultations. However, we acknowledge that misunderstandings can occur. It is also important to note that you underwent multiple trials with the joined crowns during the course of your treatment. **At no point during these trials, when the joined crowns were being assessed and adjusted, was this issue raised. Considering this, as well as the fact that you signed the satisfaction form at the conclusion of your treatment, we would like to understand why this concern was not brought up at any stage during your visits to the clinic.**

On the matter of your involvement in the decision-making process, we would like to reiterate that our clinicians discussed the treatment plan with you as part of the initial consultation. The consent form you signed explicitly states that you received full information about the proposed treatment, had the opportunity to discuss it with the dental team, and confirmed your satisfaction with the level of information provided. This consent is broad and covers the technical details discussed during consultations. While it does not specifically mention joined crowns, it reflects your acknowledgement of the comprehensive information shared during the planning stages.

Regarding your inquiry about replacing the joined crowns with individual crowns, please note that while we always ensure the highest quality of materials and workmanship in our treatments, no clinician can provide absolute assurance that there will be no risk of damage to your teeth during the replacement process. Retreatment of this nature requires careful consideration and consultation with our clinicians, as any unnecessary intervention could potentially compromise the structural integrity of your teeth.

In response to your assertion regarding the burden of evidence, we want to clarify our position. The clinical necessity letter provided by our team outlines the rationale for the treatment approach based on your specific dental condition. We requested a letter from your dentist as part of the reevaluation process only because you mentioned on WhatsApp that your dentist stated individual crowns would be a better choice. Our request for this letter was not intended to shift the responsibility but to ensure a well-rounded understanding of the situation based on another clinician's perspective.

Finally, we understand and respect your concerns. However, as a non-clinician, we kindly note that the decision regarding the healthiest and most suitable treatment option is determined by the dental team based on clinical assessments and professional expertise. This is why such decisions are made collaboratively with clinicians and supported by diagnostic evidence and finally, This is why we kindly ask for a clinical necessity letter from a clinician with expertise, such as your dentist who you mention said it is clinically better for you to have the singular crowns.

We are of course obligated, and more than happy, to provide you every detailed information you want about your process here. We are of course now sad to see that you believe we do not provide enough information since you yourself mentioned that why you choose Orbismed clinics and why you like us is because " Lots of detail " (Included in the attached file.)

We can confirm that the planned replacement of your lower crowns will proceed as scheduled during your visit from December 15–20, and we are committed to resolving this matter to your satisfaction.

We remain committed to addressing your concerns thoroughly and ensuring you are satisfied with your treatment outcomes. Should you have further questions or require additional clarification, please do not hesitate to reach out.

On Ara 10 2024, at 9:52 ös, Neill Ryan <neillk2@yahoo.com> wrote:

Dear Yagiz,

Thank you for your response regarding my treatment.

I appreciate the effort you have made to address the issues I have raised, but I remain deeply concerned with the lack of transparency and communication surrounding my procedure. This is not only a question of clinical necessity, but also one of patient consent.

The decision to use joined (splinted) crowns or bridges instead of individual crowns is a significant clinical choice that should have been clearly communicated to me before proceeding, particularly as this approach deviates from what I understood to be the agreed treatment plan.

At the point when my teeth were examined and the use of bridged crowns was deemed necessary, I should have been informed. Instead, no information was provided, my teeth were subsequently shaved, and the bridged crowns were fabricated without involving me in that decision.

While you have stated in the "Confirmation of Clinical Necessity" that joined crowns were chosen to enhance stability and ensure long-term oral health, this reasoning appears to be generic. In cases where teeth and gums are healthy, with no evidence of bone loss or mobility issues, individual crowns are widely regarded as the gold standard.

Although I had some fillings in my molars and premolars, the majority of my teeth—specifically my front teeth—were completely healthy, with no structural concerns, evidence of bone loss or mobility issues. Under these circumstances, I would appreciate a detailed explanation as to why this approach was deemed necessary for all my teeth when individual crowns should have been the first consideration. Please include my pre-treatment radiographs, photos, and periodontal assessments and a copy of the consent form I signed that explicitly states I agreed to the use of joined or bridged crowns. I would like to understand the specific defects in my front top teeth (for example) that warranted this decision.

Furthermore, I must stress that the onus is not on me to provide evidence from my dentist as to why individual crowns are preferable. It is your obligation to provide evidence as to why individual crowns were not used in my case, and explain why I was not informed of this significant deviation from the original plan prior to the procedure.

As you may already know, I have discussed the issue of my lower teeth with Gulcin, who acknowledged after seeing the images that they have been left blunt with a thick, rough edge. As such, I am scheduled to return to the clinic from the 15th to the 20th of December to address this issue, and the lower crowns are due to be replaced. Additionally, Gulcin has already confirmed that you are willing to replace the joined crowns with individual ones if I choose to proceed with this option.

If I decide to move forward with this replacement, I expect the same level of guarantees regarding the quality of the work as originally provided. I also need your assurances that my teeth will not be damaged during the replacement process. Please confirm the specific measures you will take to ensure this, and how you will address any potential damage to my teeth should it occur during the procedure.

Once again, thank you for your kind help so far. I do not wish to end up in a lengthy dispute with you but I feel my concerns are more than justified.

I look forward to your response addressing these concerns and providing clarity on the next steps.

Kind regards,
Neill Ryan

On Tuesday, December 10, 2024 at 10:33:21 AM GMT, OrbisMed Clinics - Booking
<booking@orbismedclinics.com> wrote:

Dear Mr. Ryan,

I hope this email finds you well.

As discussed over WhatsApp, we are sending you the attached Clinical Necessity Letter regarding the use of joined (splinted) crowns in your treatment. This letter outlines the technical rationale for this approach, which was chosen based on a thorough evaluation of your clinical and radiographic condition to ensure the best long-term outcomes for your dental health.

In order to proceed with a full reassessment of your treatment, we kindly request that you provide us with a clinical necessity letter from your dentist as well. explaining their rationale for preferring individual crowns over the joined crowns that were used in your case. **Once we receive this information, we will be happy to re-evaluate the situation and explore possible next steps.**

Please don't hesitate to reach out if you have any further questions or need additional information. We appreciate your understanding and cooperation in this matter.

Thank you and best regards,



Yagiz Orhan
Patient Care Director
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07230 Muratpaşa/Antalya

OrbisMed Clinics - Booking <booking@orbismedclinics.com>
To: "Neill Ryan" <neillk2@yahoo.com>

Per, Ara 12, 2024 at 11:41 ÖÖ

Hello Neill,

Thank you for your detailed message. I understand your concerns regarding the treatment plan, and I would like to address each of your points comprehensively to ensure that everything is clear and properly explained.

1. Lack of Evidence Supporting Clinical Necessity

- "You have not provided sufficient or specific evidence explaining why the use of joined crowns was necessary in my case, particularly on my healthy teeth."*

We would like to reiterate that our clinical team made the decision to use joined crowns based on their professional assessment of your specific dental condition and needs. **I have sent you a Clinical Necessity Confirmation letter, all the sufficient and specific evidence explaining why the use of joined crowns was necessary in your case is comprehensively explained in the last mail I have sent you. Please check it.** This decision was made with the intention of ensuring the long-term stability and functionality of your dental restorations. While we respect your preference for individual crowns, it's important to emphasize that treatment decisions are ultimately determined by our clinicians' expertise and judgment, guided by diagnostic evidence and best practices.

Furthermore, a detailed analysis of your pre-treatment tomography revealed significant crowding and tilting of your lower anterior teeth. This crowding, characterized by insufficient space between adjacent teeth, presented a challenge for the placement of individual crowns. Opting for individual crowns in this situation would have necessitated excessive preparation (shaving) of your teeth to create adequate space, potentially compromising their structural integrity and long-term health.

The use of joined crowns in this scenario is supported by dental literature, which indicates that splinting can be beneficial in cases of crowded or misaligned teeth. Joined crowns provide enhanced stability and distribute occlusal forces more evenly, reducing the risk of complications such as tooth fracture or loosening. This approach aligns with the principles of conservative dentistry, which prioritizes the preservation of natural tooth structure whenever possible.

2. No Documentation of Informed Consent

- *"There is no documentation showing that I had prior knowledge of the use of 12 joined crowns or that I gave my informed consent for this significant deviation from the agreed treatment plan of 26 crowns."*

The treatment plan was adapted during the fitting to optimize the final result. Signature authorization for literally every step of the process is not obligatory as you have provided full and broad consent. What you are describing is inherently incompatible with the concept of consent and it is not even legally plausible. You were informed verbally during the fitting. The signed consent form covered the general treatment, as it states:

"I have received the full information about my proposed dental treatment to include the full terms and conditions of my dental guarantee. I have discussed my treatment with the dental team and have been given an opportunity to ask questions and have them fully answered. I can confirm that I am happy with the level of information provided and everything has been explained to me during my consultation. I fully understand the nature of the proposed dental treatment(s). I understand should I choose to proceed with the proposed dental treatment(s) that they are my financial responsibility."

Since the consent is broad and the remaining steps are explained verbally, we do not require signatures for each individual step of treatment. This process is common practice and is consistent with legal standards worldwide.

Furthermore, it's important to highlight that you also signed a **satisfaction form upon completion of your treatment**, confirming that the treatment was completed to your satisfaction. This indicates your acceptance of the final outcome, including the use of joined crowns.

! As stated in my last mail which you have not responded to:

In response to your concern that this treatment approach was not communicated to you before the procedure, we want to emphasize that our clinicians make every effort to communicate the details of the proposed treatments during consultations. However, we acknowledge that misunderstandings can occur. It is also important to note that you underwent multiple trials with the joined crowns during the course of your treatment.

- **At no point during these trials, when the joined crowns were being assessed and adjusted, was this issue raised. Considering this, as well as the fact that you signed the satisfaction form at the conclusion of your treatment, we would like to understand why this concern was not brought up at any stage during your visits to the clinic.**

To conclude;

We would like to understand why this concern was not brought up at any stage during your visits to the clinic.

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3. Timing of Communication

- *"The decision to use joined crowns was communicated to me only at the final fitting stage, leaving me no opportunity to make an informed decision."*

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4. And finally, the last part of your email, which is about the actions you believe are required:

- *I still require an explanation for these deviations from the agreed treatment plan and documentation substantiating the necessity of using joined crowns on normal, healthy teeth.*

Regarding your request for further evidence supporting the clinical necessity of joined crowns, we have already provided a detailed explanation in the clinical necessity letter, along with your full medical history, original treatment plan, pre- and post-treatment X-rays, the signed consent form, the signed satisfaction form, and your invoice. These documents collectively illustrate the rationale behind the treatment decisions made in your case.

I trust this clarifies your concerns. We appreciate your understanding and cooperation in this matter.

Kindest regards,



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At the point when my teeth were examined and the use of bridged crowns was deemed necessary, I should have been informed. Instead, no information was provided, my teeth were subsequently shaved, and the bridged crowns were fabricated without involving me in that decision.

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Neill Ryan <neillk2@yahoo.com>
To: "OrbisMed Clinics - Booking" <booking@orbismedclinics.com>

Per, Ara 12, 2024 at 12:54 ÖS

Hi Yagiz

Your comments have been noted.

Please can you get back to me regarding the proposed treatment plan for this coming week and my lower teeth?

Neill Ryan

[Sent from Yahoo Mail for iPhone](#)

On Thursday, December 12, 2024, 8:41 am, OrbisMed Clinics - Booking <booking@orbismedclinics.com> wrote:

Hello Neill,

Thank you for your detailed message. I understand your concerns regarding the treatment plan, and I would like to address each of your points comprehensively to ensure that everything is clear and properly explained.

1. Lack of Evidence Supporting Clinical Necessity

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- At no point during these trials, when the joined crowns were being assessed and adjusted, was this issue raised. Considering this, as well as the fact that you signed the satisfaction form at the conclusion of your treatment, we would like to understand why this concern was not brought up at any stage during your visits to the clinic.

To conclude;

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Kindest regards,

**Yagiz Orhan**

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OrbisMed Clinics

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On Ara 11 2024, at 5:03 ös, Neill Ryan <neillk2@yahoo.com> wrote:

Dear Yagiz,

Thank you for providing the documents related to my treatment. After reviewing the consent form and associated paperwork, I remain unconvinced that my concerns have been adequately addressed.

While the consent form I signed acknowledges my agreement to undergo treatment, it does not explicitly state or provide details about the use of joined (splinted) crowns. The paperwork I signed specifically refers to 26 zirconium crowns, with no mention of any changes to the proposed plan or the use of 12 joined crowns (5 lower and 7 upper), which is what I have ended up with.

The reason I could not have consented to the treatment I received is because the very first time I was made aware of the use of joined crowns was during the fitting process, which, as you know, occurs some days after the consent form is signed.

At this time, the use of joined crowns was not presented to me as my choice but was explained to me as a "standard procedure." I was simply shown some of my joined crowns after they had been made and told, words to the effect of, "this is the way we do it because it's better."

It was my belief at that time that OrbisMed uses joined crowns in all cases and that there was no other option for me. At this stage, with my teeth already shaved and a flight home scheduled for the next morning, I was in absolutely no position to weigh up the risks or benefits or properly consent.

If OrbisMed believes that this would constitute informed patient consent, then this would be very concerning indeed.

Summary of Key Concerns:**1. Lack of Evidence Supporting Clinical Necessity,**

You have not provided sufficient or specific evidence explaining why the use of joined crowns was necessary in my case, particularly on my healthy teeth.

2. No Documentation of Informed Consent

There is no documentation showing that I had prior knowledge of the use of 12 joined crowns or that I gave my informed consent for this significant deviation from the agreed treatment plan of 26 crowns.

3. Timing of Communication

The decision to use joined crowns was communicated to me only at the final fitting stage, leaving me no opportunity to make an informed decision.

Actions Required

I still require an explanation for these deviations from the agreed treatment plan and documentation substantiating the necessity of using joined crowns on normal, healthy teeth.

Additionally, I would like confirmation of the specific measures you will take to address my concerns, including the possibility of replacing joined crowns with individual crowns, as previously discussed.

Proposal for Lower Teeth Replacement

Furthermore, I would like to fully understand the proposal for my lower teeth. How will these be replaced, and what assurances can you provide that my teeth will not be harmed during this

process? If any of my underlying teeth are compromised during the replacement process, what solution will be offered?

I trust you will take my concerns seriously and provide a comprehensive response that addresses them fully.

Kind regards,

Neill Ryan

On Wednesday, December 11, 2024 at 09:20:43 AM GMT, OrbisMed Clinics - Booking <booking@orbismedclinics.com> wrote:

Thank you for your detailed email and for sharing your concerns regarding your treatment. We understand the importance of addressing your points comprehensively and transparently, and we are committed to working with you to clarify and resolve these matters.

Firstly, regarding the clinical justification for the use of joined (splinted) crowns, we have already provided a detailed explanation in the clinical necessity letter sent in our prior correspondence. In addition to this, as part of our commitment to transparency, we are attaching the following documents for your review:

- Your full medical history
- The original treatment plan
- Pre- and post-treatment X-rays
- The signed consent form
- The signed satisfaction form
- Your invoice

These documents should provide a clear overview of the clinical decision-making process and the steps taken during your treatment.

In response to your concern that this treatment approach was not communicated to you before the procedure, we want to emphasize that our clinicians make every effort to communicate the details of the proposed treatments during consultations. However, we acknowledge that misunderstandings can occur. It is also important to note that you underwent multiple trials with the joined crowns during the course of your treatment. **At no point during these trials, when the joined crowns were being assessed and adjusted, was this issue raised. Considering this, as well as the fact that you signed the satisfaction form at the conclusion of your treatment, we would like to understand why this concern was not brought up at any stage during your visits to the clinic.**

On the matter of your involvement in the decision-making process, we would like to reiterate that our clinicians discussed the treatment plan with you as part of the initial consultation. The consent form you signed explicitly states that you received full information about the proposed treatment, had the opportunity to discuss it with the dental team, and confirmed your satisfaction with the level of information provided. This consent is broad and covers the technical details discussed during consultations. While it does not specifically mention joined crowns, it reflects your acknowledgement of the comprehensive information shared during the planning stages.

Regarding your inquiry about replacing the joined crowns with individual crowns, please note that while we always ensure the highest quality of materials and workmanship in our treatments, no clinician can provide absolute assurance that there will be no risk of damage to your teeth during the replacement process. Retreatment of this nature

requires careful consideration and consultation with our clinicians, as any unnecessary intervention could potentially compromise the structural integrity of your teeth.

In response to your assertion regarding the burden of evidence, we want to clarify our position. The clinical necessity letter provided by our team outlines the rationale for the treatment approach based on your specific dental condition. We requested a letter from your dentist as part of the reevaluation process only because you mentioned on WhatsApp that your dentist stated individual crowns would be a better choice. Our request for this letter was not intended to shift the responsibility but to ensure a well-rounded understanding of the situation based on another clinician's perspective.

Finally, we understand and respect your concerns. However, as a non-clinician, we kindly note that the decision regarding the healthiest and most suitable treatment option is determined by the dental team based on clinical assessments and professional expertise. This is why such decisions are made collaboratively with clinicians and supported by diagnostic evidence and finally, This is why we kindly ask for a clinical necessity letter from a clinician with expertise, such as your dentist who you mention said it is clinically better for you to have the singular crowns.

We are of course obligated, and more than happy, to provide you every detailed information you want about your process here. We are of of course now sad to see that you believe we do not provide enough information since you yourself mentioned that why you choose Orbismed clinics and why you like us is because " Lots of detail " (Included in the attached file.)

We can confirm that the planned replacement of your lower crowns will proceed as scheduled during your visit from December 15–20, and we are committed to resolving this matter to your satisfaction.

We remain committed to addressing your concerns thoroughly and ensuring you are satisfied with your treatment outcomes. Should you have further questions or require additional clarification, please do not hesitate to reach out.

On Ara 10 2024, at 9:52 ös, Neill Ryan <neillk2@yahoo.com> wrote:

Dear Yagiz,

Thank you for your response regarding my treatment.

I appreciate the effort you have made to address the issues I have raised, but I remain deeply concerned with the lack of transparency and communication surrounding my procedure. This is not only a question of clinical necessity, but also one of patient consent.

The decision to use joined (splinted) crowns or bridges instead of individual crowns is a significant clinical choice that should have been clearly communicated to me before proceeding, particularly as this approach deviates from what I understood to be the agreed treatment plan.

At the point when my teeth were examined and the use of bridged crowns was deemed necessary, I should have been informed. Instead, no information was provided, my teeth were subsequently shaved, and the bridged crowns were fabricated without involving me in that decision.

While you have stated in the "Confirmation of Clinical Necessity" that joined crowns were chosen to enhance stability and ensure long-term oral health, this reasoning appears to be generic. In cases where teeth and gums are healthy, with no evidence of bone loss or mobility issues, individual crowns are widely regarded as the gold standard.

Although I had some fillings in my molars and premolars, the majority of my teeth—specifically my front teeth—were completely healthy, with no structural concerns, evidence of bone loss or mobility issues. Under these circumstances, I would appreciate a detailed explanation as to why this approach was deemed necessary for all my teeth when individual crowns should have been the first consideration. Please include my pre-treatment radiographs, photos, and periodontal

assessments and a copy of the consent form I signed that explicitly states I agreed to the use of joined or bridged crowns. I would like to understand the specific defects in my front top teeth (for example) that warranted this decision.

Furthermore, I must stress that the onus is not on me to provide evidence from my dentist as to why individual crowns are preferable. It is your obligation to provide evidence as to why individual crowns were not used in my case, and explain why I was not informed of this significant deviation from the original plan prior to the procedure.

As you may already know, I have discussed the issue of my lower teeth with Gulcin, who acknowledged after seeing the images that they have been left blunt with a thick, rough edge. As such, I am scheduled to return to the clinic from the 15th to the 20th of December to address this issue, and the lower crowns are due to be replaced. Additionally, Gulcin has already confirmed that you are willing to replace the joined crowns with individual ones if I choose to proceed with this option.

If I decide to move forward with this replacement, I expect the same level of guarantees regarding the quality of the work as originally provided. I also need your assurances that my teeth will not be damaged during the replacement process. Please confirm the specific measures you will take to ensure this, and how you will address any potential damage to my teeth should it occur during the procedure.

Once again, thank you for your kind help so far. I do not wish to end up in a lengthy dispute with you but I feel my concerns are more than justified.

I look forward to your response addressing these concerns and providing clarity on the next steps.

Kind regards,
Neill Ryan

On Tuesday, December 10, 2024 at 10:33:21 AM GMT, OrbisMed Clinics - Booking
<booking@orbismedclinics.com> wrote:

Dear Mr. *Ryan*,

I hope this email finds you well.

As discussed over WhatsApp, we are sending you the attached Clinical Necessity Letter regarding the use of joined (splinted) crowns in your treatment. This letter outlines the technical rationale for this approach, which was chosen based on a thorough evaluation of your clinical and radiographic condition to ensure the best long-term outcomes for your dental health.

In order to proceed with a full reassessment of your treatment, we kindly request that you provide us with a clinical necessity letter from your dentist as well, explaining their rationale for preferring individual crowns over the joined crowns that were used in your case. ***Once we receive this information, we will be happy to re-evaluate the situation and explore possible next steps.***

Please don't hesitate to reach out if you have any further questions or need additional information. We appreciate your understanding and cooperation in this matter.

Thank you and best regards,



**Yagiz
Orhan**

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